uses 1 per cent of the land mass, contributes 80 per cent. The productivity of land use in non-agriculture and agriculture thus gives a ratio of approximately 1:200.

The Government of India Owns More than a Million Hectares of Land

The Government of India created a system of collecting information about the land owned and controlled by different ministries, departments, PSUs and other public entities. In October 2017, it released information about such owned and controlled land. It revealed that the Government of India owned 13505.44 sq. km. of land, or 1.35 million hectares.

The Railways owned 2929.6 sq. km., the Ministry of Coal and related companies owned 2580.92 sq. km., the Ministry of Power and its enterprises owned 1806.69 sq. km., Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises owned 1209.49 sq. km. and Ministry of Shipping owned 1146 sq. km. The Ministries of Steel, Agriculture, Home Affairs, Human Resources Department and Defence owned lands between 300 and 600 sq. km.

That the land owned by the government is substantial can be gauged by the fact that built-up land in India, as per satellite surveys, was only 2.04 million hectares in 2010. While a good part of the land said to be owned by the Government of India or central public-sector undertakings is for mining leases, the land owned by the Ministry of Railways and Ministry of Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises, which is good for industrial and residential development, exceeds 0.4 million hectares.